

HOUSE RESOLUTION 294

By Pearson

A RESOLUTION to honor Memphis Community Against Pollution (MCAP) and its president, KeShaun Pearson, on the fifth anniversary of the cancellation of the Byhalia Connection Pipeline project in Southwest Memphis.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body take great pride in recognizing individuals and organizations whose courage, advocacy, and commitment to justice have strengthened communities across the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Memphis Community Against Pollution (MCAP) has emerged as a leading grassroots organization dedicated to protecting the health, environment, and civil rights of residents in Southwest Memphis and beyond; and

WHEREAS, under the leadership of its president, KeShaun Pearson, MCAP has championed environmental justice by organizing, educating, and mobilizing community members to stand against environmental hazards disproportionately impacting historically Black and economically disadvantaged neighborhoods; and

WHEREAS, the proposed Byhalia Connection Pipeline project threatened to run a crude oil pipeline through Southwest Memphis, placing drinking water, air quality, and the overall well-being of thousands of residents at risk; and

WHEREAS, through steadfast advocacy, coalition building, and unwavering community engagement, MCAP and its allies successfully opposed the pipeline, culminating in the cancellation of the Byhalia Connection Pipeline project, a landmark victory for environmental justice; and

WHEREAS, the cancellation of the pipeline stands as a powerful testament to the strength of grassroots organizing and the fundamental principle that all people, regardless of race, income, or geography, deserve clean air, safe water, and a healthy environment; and

WHEREAS, on the fifth anniversary of this historic achievement, it is fitting to honor MCAP and Mr. Pearson for their leadership, resilience, and enduring commitment to justice, equity, and the protection of future generations; and

WHEREAS, their work continues to inspire movements across Tennessee and the nation, serving as a beacon of hope and a model for community-driven change; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we hereby honor Memphis Community Against Pollution (MCAP) and its president, KeShaun Pearson, on the fifth anniversary of the cancellation of the Byhalia Connection Pipeline project and commend their extraordinary contributions to environmental justice and community empowerment.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.